

01 SMALL TALK

When a friend asks how they look in new clothes, do you say what you really think?

Do you share your opinion fast, or do you take your time first?

When something is on your mind, do you talk about it or keep it inside?

02 POP QUIZ — DOES THIS SOUND NATURAL?

1 ~~"I have a some with him."~~

✓ "There's something going on between us."

한국어 '썸'은 영어에 없어요. something going on / a thing 으로 풀어 써요.

2 ~~"We meeting for 3 months."~~

✓ "We've been seeing each other for 3 months."

3개월째 이어지는 일은 현재완료진행이고, 연애는 meeting보다 seeing each other가 자연스러워요.

3 ~~"He gave me a big impression."~~

✓ "He made a strong impression on me."

인상은 make an impression on someone, 크기는 big이 아니라 strong을 써요.

03 오늘의 워업

각 질문에 A 또는 B 손가락으로 표시. 마음에 드는 거 하나만 짧게 이유.

WARM-UP

Quick Choice (5분)

1 If you dislike your friend's partner, do you (A) say it honestly or (B) stay quiet?

2 Is it better to (A) talk about one thing they did or (B) just say "I don't like them"?

3 Before you share your opinion, do you (A) ask how your friend feels first or (B) tell your friend what you think first?

4 If your friend ignores your worry, do you (A) say it one more time or (B) let it go and trust their choice?

LOVE · MAIN DISCUSSION

When You Dislike Your Friend's Partner — Say It or Stay Quiet?

BACKGROUND

친구가 만나는 사람이 마음에 들지 않을 때는 어디까지 말해도 되는지가 조심스러워요. 친구를 걱정해서 솔직히 말하고 싶지만, 너무 강하게 말하면 친구의 선택을 무시하는 것처럼 들릴 수 있어요. 반대로 아무 말도 안 하면 나중에 문제가 커졌을 때 모른 척한 느낌이 들 수도 있죠. 중요한 건 상대를 평가하는 말보다 내가 본 구체적인 행동과 친구의 감정을 먼저 묻는 방식이에요.

READ BEFORE WE TALK

When you dislike a friend's partner, being honest feels risky. Speaking up can protect your friend if you notice disrespect, control, or a worrying pattern. But if you just dislike the person's personality, your comment can sound judgmental and make your friend defensive. Staying quiet avoids conflict, but it can feel wrong if the situation becomes serious. The best choice usually depends on the reason, the timing, and how close the friendship is. Instead of attacking the partner, it may be better to describe one specific moment and ask how your friend felt. Care needs honesty, but it also needs humility. Before speaking up, people often have to tell a real red flag apart from a simple personality mismatch. The closer the friendship, the more carefully the concern should be shared. The goal is usually not to control the relationship, but to protect trust.

WORDS YOU MIGHT NEED

It's not my place to say. — 내가 말할 자리는 아니야.

I have mixed feelings about it. — 복잡한 감정이 들어.

That's a red flag. — 그건 위험 신호야.

It's a deal-breaker for me. — 나한테 절대 안 되는 조건이야.

I don't want to ruin the mood. — 분위기를 깨고 싶지 않아.

It's totally your call. — 결정은 완전히 네 몫이야.

TRY THESE PHRASES

Honestly, I'd probably say something — but only after thinking carefully.

It depends on how close we are, but usually I would speak up gently.

The way I see it, a real red flag is when someone tries to control their partner.

What worries me most is disrespect — when one person never listens to the other.

EASY ENTRY

- 1 Are you more of a 'first impressions stick' person, or do you give your friend's new partner a few meetings before deciding?
- 2 When was the last time a friend introduced you to someone they were dating? What was your first reaction?
- 3 Quick — if you had to pick: when you meet a friend's partner, do you notice their manners, how they treat your friend, or the overall vibe first?
- 4 On a scale of 1 to 5, how often do your friends ask what you think about the person they're dating?

MAIN DISCUSSION

Q1. If you didn't like your close friend's partner, would you say something or stay quiet? Why?

↳ *Honestly, I'd probably say something — but only after thinking carefully.*

↳ *It depends on how close we are, but usually I would speak up gently.*

Q2. What is a real red flag for you, not just a personality you don't like?

↳ *The way I see it, a real red flag is when someone tries to control their partner.*

↳ *What worries me most is disrespect — when one person never listens to the other.*

Q3. How would you share your worry without sounding like you're attacking the partner?

↳ *What helps me is starting with a question instead of a judgment.*

↳ *Instead of blaming the partner, I'd focus on my friend's feelings, like 'Are you okay?'*

Q4. If your friend looked really happy with this person, would that change what you say?

↳ *If my friend looked truly happy, I'd probably step back and stay quiet.*

↳ *Their happiness matters more than my opinion, so I would say much less.*

Q5. Do you think being too honest can hurt a friendship? Why or why not?

↳ *I'd say yes, because the problem is often the timing, not the truth itself.*

↳ *Compared to staying silent, too much honesty can sometimes feel like a weapon.*